

Download request

Dear Digit,
Why don't you start a 'requests' section which includes software and downloads that readers want to see on the CD? Considering the bandwidth that is available to most of us I think it would really be appreciated.

BRIJENDRA CHAUDHARY

Via e-mail

digit

Hello Brijendra,
Even today the software that we include in the CD is driven by e-mail requests that we receive from our readers. If there is a particular download that you would like to ask for, just write us at cdcontent@jasubhai.com

digit

Hello Vishal,
While the idea of using icons to represent the different licenses for the software has occurred to us in the past, quite often it doesn't turn out to be specific as required. For example, some software is free for personal use but not for commercial use. Similarly there are distinctions

in trial software too; some are time limited whereas others are feature limited.

As you can imagine, these subtle differences cannot be accurately demonstrated by the use of a simple graphical icon, which is why we continue to use simple text to spell it out for you.

Iconic CDs

Hi,

Please try and use some kind of symbols or icons to make it easier for us to differentiate between shareware and freeware on the Mindware CD.

VISHAL DOSHI

Via e-mail

Gypping guarantees

Hi Karan,

I am an established photographer and got hooked to digital imaging a little over two years ago. To meet the increased demand of storing scanned images I bought a 20 GB drive about six months ago. A month back, the vendor I bought my PC from commented that the drive was more noisy than normal and might crash shortly. The service technician that the drive vendor sent over insisted that there was nothing to worry about and that the drive was fine even though it was making some weird noises.

A couple of days later my PC flashed me a warning about impending failure of my drive. The technician took away the drive and claimed that the data would be

recovered and the drive returned in a couple of days. A week later I got to know that I lost about 8 MB of data which constituted over 40 hours of painstaking work. To add insult to injury, I had to pay Rs 1,750 as an 'upgrade price' for a 30 GB drive because I couldn't get a 20 GB replacement. All this is despite the fact that this was a product from a manufacturer that claims to be the world leader in hard disk drives and was purchased from an authorised distributor.

This has left me extremely annoyed as well as disappointed. Is this the best that can be expected from a warranty, even one coming from an international brand?

Sincerely

SWAPAN MUKHERJEE

Via e-mail

digit

Hello Swapan,
Your story and those of several others that wrote in to relate similar experiences prompted us to take an even closer look at how product warranties are honoured.

There are several things that you can do to protect yourself against such problems. First, you need to pay a lot more attention to this when you are actually making a purchase. Take the time to locate local service centre for the product and try sticking to the brands that have their own service setup in India (this is not true for all brands). Make sure that you get a proper warranty card and that you get a clear understanding of the dealers or service centres' interpretation of the terms of the warranty.

The only way you can avoid this particular situation in the future is by making it very clear to your vendor, at the outset, that you are not going to let him take you for a ride.

Goof Ups

■ Saikiran has rightly pointed out that we goofed up in the IDE hard disk drives test. The IBM DeskStar 60GXP (41 GB) drive has a sequential write speed of 39 MBps as stated in the write-up and not 11 MBps as mentioned in the bar graph.

■ Oops! In the e-books section of the Digit Mindware CD, the blurbs for Arthur Conan Doyle's *The Adventure of the Devil's Foot* and Edgar Rice Burroughs' *At the Earth's Core* are the same as that for Jane Austen's *Sense and Sensibility*. Thanks Satish Kumar, for pointing it out to us.

Notice any goof-ups? Write to goof@jasubhai.com

Short Bytes

Diverse drivers

Dear Karan,

In the article 'As Easy As Pie' (Digit, October 2001), you have mentioned something called 'thermal paste'. What exactly is this thermal paste and how does it work?

S. Balguru

Via e-mail.

Thermal paste is what helps the heatsink do its job of helping the processor keep its cool. It's a compound that allows you to fill all the gaps between the processor surface and the heatsink surface. It serves as a 'heatbond' that aids in transmitting heat from the processor to the heatsink.

A sticky situation

Hello Digit,

The adhesive that you use on the sticking tape that closes the CD packet is too strong and tears the packet every time I open them. Please consider an alternative sealing idea.

Via e-mail

If you have suggestions on how to make Digit better, come participate in the reader survey at <http://www.thinkdigit.com/survey/betterdigit>

Send your letters marked 'Readers Letters' to the Digit office:
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